Quick-Start Intake Guide

Fraternal Council Archives™

Offline print edition

Compiled 2026-10-29 from docs/QUICK_START_INTAKE_GUIDE.md

Fraternal Council Archives™ — Quick-Start Intake Guide

Audience: the council Admin who sets up a new council on the platform.

Covers: the five steps of the **Council Setup Wizard** on the **Admin Desk**. The full instructions are in the *Administrator User Guide*, chapter 16.

> **Who can do this:** council Admins and Super Admins. Other members do not see the Admin Desk or the wizard.

Contents

- 1. Start the wizard, the roster, storage and email
- 2. The founding template and the practice sandbox
- 3. The Quick-Start Guide and the Admin Desk

---

1. Start the wizard, the roster, storage and email

1.1 Start the Council Setup Wizard

The wizard covers the **Admin Desk** until you finish it or skip it. The wizard opens by itself when your council has no accounts and no members other than you.

Start point: Sidebar → System Settings → **Admin Desk**.

Steps:

1. If the wizard is not open, select **Run Setup Wizard** at the top of the Admin Desk.
2. Read the step title and the sentence below it.
3. Select **Next** to go to the next step. Select **Back** to go to the step before.
4. To close the wizard now, select **Skip for now**. You can open it again at any time.

Expected result: The wizard shows **Step 1 of 5**.

Each step has a **?** mark next to its hard fields. Select the **?** mark to read what the field does.

1.2 Step 1: Supreme CSV Roster Ingestion

Goal: Add the council's members from the Supreme roster export.

Steps:

1. Get the roster export from Supreme. Save it as CSV. Keep its **First Degree Date** column.
2. Drop the file on the upload area, or select the area and choose the file.
3. Make sure that the row count is correct.
4. Select **Sync**.

Expected result: The wizard shows how many members were added, changed or skipped. Each new member gets a welcome email with a one-time setup code.

Problem	Cause	Fix
A row is skipped.	The email already belongs to another member.	Correct the email in the file. Sync again.
You do not have the file yet.	The export is not ready.	Select **Next**. Import the roster later on the **Financial Secretary Desk**.

1.3 Step 2: File Storage and Email Gateway

Goal: Choose where council files are kept, and connect the mail server the portal sends from.

Steps:

1. In **File Repository**, choose the storage provider. Fill in the folder fields. Select **Save**.
2. In **Outbound Email**, choose the email provider.
3. Type the server, the username and the password.
4. Select **Save**.

Expected result: The password goes to the **Secure Access Vault**. The vault seals it and keeps it for your home council only. The page never shows the password again.

> **Note:** The wizard saves keys only for your own home council. A Super Admin of another council cannot read them. Council mail goes from this server; platform notices come from `tim@fairmissionsoftware.com`.

2. The founding template and the practice sandbox

2.1 Step 3: Clone Founding Template

Goal: Copy the setup of Founding Council 15295 in one click.

Steps:

1. Select ⚡ **Clone Founding Template**.
2. Wait for the message.

Expected result: The message shows how many items were copied:

Copied	From Council 15295
Accounts	The chart of accounts, with the parent of each account
Activities	The activity list, each **Active** or **Inactive**
Donation types	The donation type list
Payment methods	The enabled payment methods and their linked accounts
Settings	The **Council Wide Settings** limits

The clone keeps every item your council already has with the same name. You can select the button again; it copies only what is missing. Contacts, QR images, savings goal accounts and sister-council accounts are not copied.

2.2 Step 4: Practice Sandbox

Goal: Try every desk with practice data before real members use the portal.

Steps:

1. Select **Activate Safe Practice Sandbox**.

Expected result: The platform adds 10 practice members and 3 practice fundraisers. Each fundraiser has one shift with 3 practice volunteers. Practice members get no email. Practice fundraisers start with **[Practice]**.

To remove the practice data, go to the top of the **Admin Desk**. Turn off the **Practice Sandbox** switch.

Problem	Cause	Fix
The switch says a donation is recorded.	Someone recorded a donation on a practice fundraiser.	Remove the donation. Turn off the switch again.

3. The Quick-Start Guide and the Admin Desk

3.1 Step 5: Download the guide and open the desk

Goal: Keep this guide, then start work on the Admin Desk.

Steps:

1. Select **Download the Quick-Start Intake Guide**.
2. Select **Open the Admin Desk**.

Expected result: The wizard closes. The Admin Desk shows the top deck and the six drawers. The wizard does not open by itself again in this browser.

Disclaimer

Informational notice. This guide describes the Fraternal Council Archives™ for the council officers and administrators who run it. It is provided for information only. It is not an official publication of the Knights of Columbus Supreme Council, and it does not replace the Charter, Constitution and Laws of the Order, the council's bylaws, the forms the Supreme Council prescribes, or the advice of a qualified accountant, auditor or attorney. Screens, roles and rules can change between releases. Where this guide and the portal differ, the portal and the governing documents of the Order prevail.